

The Human-AI Partnership Framework

Where human judgment belongs

Reward-to-Retain

PCF 7.5 — Reward & Retain Talent — Value Stream Profile

This value stream comprises one APQC PCF process group: 7.5 Reward and Retain Employees — spanning 5 Level 3 processes and 17 Level 4 activities.

At the activity level, this value stream's work breaks down as 9 Knowledge activities (judgment, synthesis, and interpretation-driven work), 7 Transaction activities (rules-based processing suited to automation), and 1 Document activity (content generation). No Exception-pattern activity exists within this value stream.

At M3 (HITL Design Intent), the value stream's aggregate human-involvement ratio is 51%, down from a 74% undesigned baseline — a 23-point AI convergence opportunity.

L3 PROCESSES	L4 ACTIVITIES	M1 BASELINE H%	M3 DESIGN INTENT H%	Δ M1 → M3
5	17	74%	51%	-23%

KPIs

Business Impact Metric & Formula (where confirmed)	Source
Regrettable turnover rate <i>Voluntary exits of high-performing/critical-skill employees ÷ average headcount, measured annually</i>	SHRM
Compensation competitiveness <i>Pay rate ÷ pay range midpoint (compa-ratio), aggregated as average compa-ratio across employees in scope</i>	SHRM
Benefits cost trend <i>Total benefits spend this period ÷ total benefits spend prior period – 1, tracked year-over-year</i>	—

Design Narrative

Reward-to-Retain has no Decision-pattern activity and no Executive-tier accountability anywhere in this value stream — human judgment here is concentrated in Knowledge-pattern program design and review work (7.5.1's compensation-structure design and recurring plan-review cadence, 7.5.3's work/life balance and family-support program delivery) rather than in formal approval gates. The value stream also introduces its first genuine cross-functional accountability boundary: 7.5.4 Administer Payroll is Accountable to HRIS Analyst but explicitly scoped to HR-owned personnel data, with Finance owning the payroll run itself as an external participant. The steepest AI-absorption opportunity sits in 7.5.5 (Manage/Collect Employee Suggestions and Research, Document-pattern, -32 points), the value stream's only Document-pattern content.

AI Capability Map

Pattern-type distribution across this value stream's activity units. H% figures are the pattern type's standard value at each maturity level, applied consistently across all PCF domains.

Decision <i>Judgment & Authority — gates that stay human by design</i> 0 L4 activities <i>No activities of this pattern in this value stream</i>	Knowledge <i>Synthesis & Interpretation — judgment-driven work</i> 9 L4 activities M1 85% → M3 65%	Document <i>Content Generation — drafting and communication</i> 1 L4 activities M1 72% → M3 40%	Transaction <i>Rules-Based Processing — suited to automation</i> 7 L4 activities M1 60% → M3 35%	Exception <i>Non-Standard Resolution — human-resolved by nature</i> 0 L4 activities <i>No activities of this pattern in this value stream</i>
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Process Accountability

Process Accountability	Tier	L3 Processes	L4 Activities
Compensation & Benefits Manager	Managerial	7.5.1	9
Compensation Analyst	Operational	7.5.2	4
HR Generalist	Operational	7.5.3, 7.5.5	3
HRIS Analyst (HR-owned scope)	External Participant	7.5.4	1

Handoff Points

The value stream opens with Compensation & Benefits Manager (7.5.1), who owns the largest single L3 in Reward-to-Retain — compensation structure design, administration, and the recurring review cadence all sit in one lane.

7.5.2 Manage and Administer Benefits hands off to Compensation Analyst for fully operational, Transaction-pattern execution — enrollment, claims processing, and reconciliation — with Compensation & Benefits Manager retained as Consulted.

HR Generalist owns two separate pieces of the value stream — employee assistance and retention program delivery (7.5.3) and employee suggestion/research program administration (7.5.5). HRIS Analyst's single step (7.5.4 Administer Payroll) marks the value stream's only genuine cross-functional boundary: HR's accountability there is explicitly scoped to personnel data, with Finance owning the payroll run and payroll accounting outside this process flow entirely.

Governed Decision Points

No Decision- or Exception-pattern activity in this value stream — every step here is Knowledge, Document, Transaction, or Mixed without an embedded Decision/Exception component.

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